

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



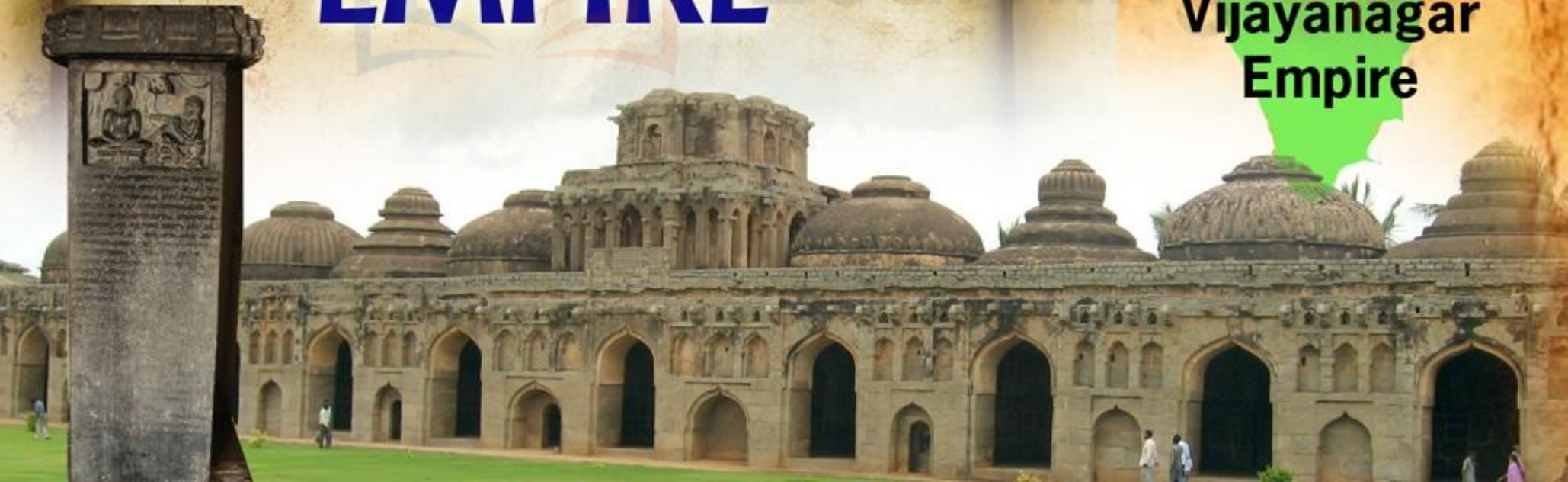
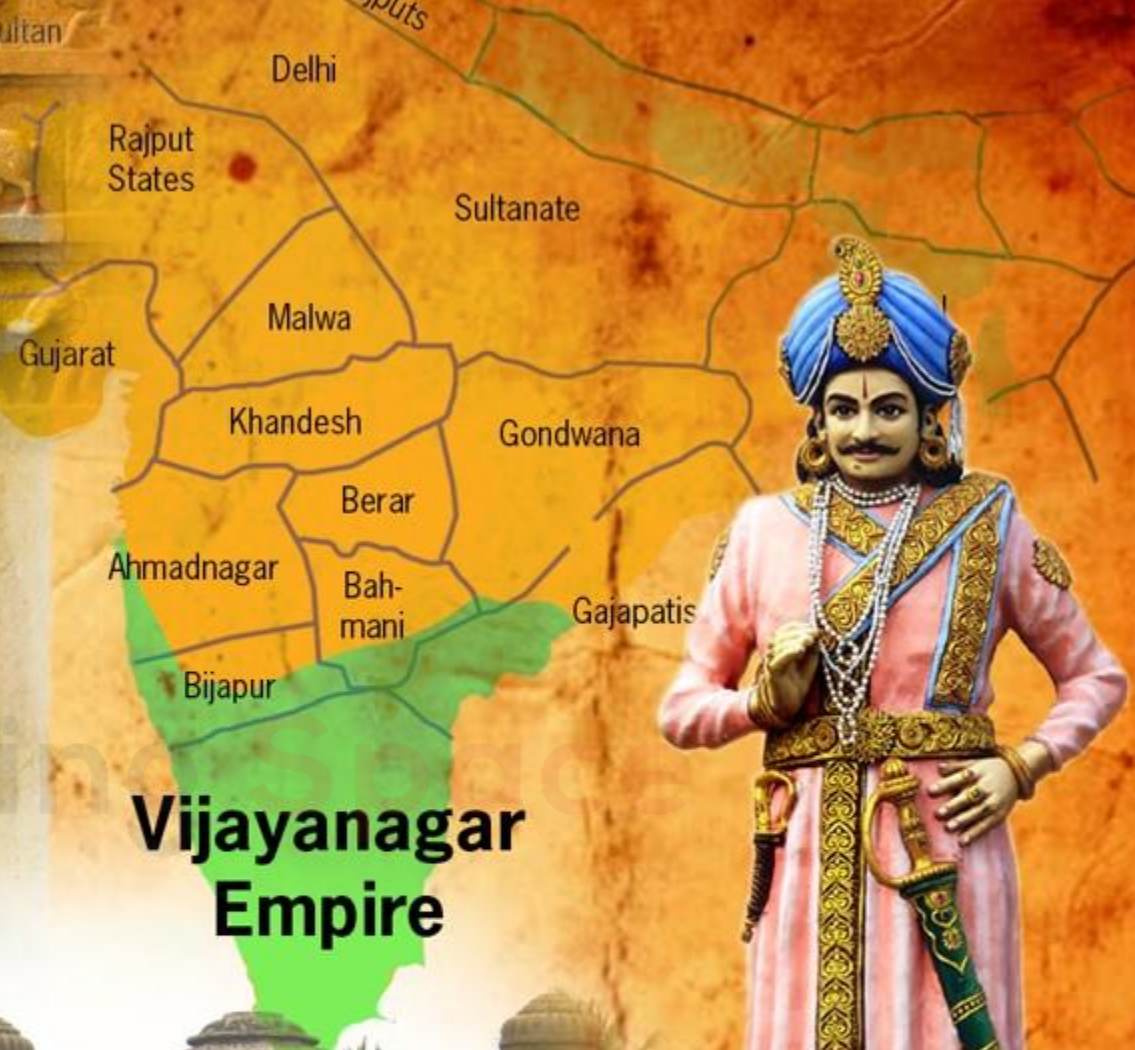
MODULE - 18

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE PART - 2





VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE



VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

KRISHNA DEVA RAYA (1509–1529 AD)



- 1 The Tuluva dynasty was founded by **Narasanayaka** (not Vira Narasimha)
- 2 The greatest of the Vijayanagar rulers, was also known as '**Abhinava Bhoja**', '**Andhra Pitamah**', '**Andhra Bhoja**' (as he was great patron of literature and art).
- 3
 - He was a great commander and an efficient administrator.
 - He fought a series of war with the independent kingdoms (Deccan Sultanates) that came up on the ruins of the Bahmani kingdom.
 - The Muslim armies were decisively defeated in The **Battle Of Diwani**.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

KRISHNA DEVA RAYA (1509–1529 AD)



4 Then he invaded the Raichur Doab and completely shattered the Adil Shahi forces of Bijapur he then captured the city of Raichur in 1520 AD, and set free the three Bahmani princes who were imprisoned there.

5 He thus restored the Bahmani Sultanate to Muhammad Shah.

6 He defeated the Gajapathi ruler Prataparudra and conquered the whole of Telangana.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

KRISHNA DEVA RAYA (C.1509–1529 CE)



7 He compelled the ruler of Orissa to restore to Vijaynagar all the territories up to the river Krishna

8 He dealt with the Portuguese influence in the Deccan. He maintained friendly relations with the Portuguese. King Albuquerque sent his ambassadors to the court of Krishna Deva Raya.

9 The Portuguese travelers Domingo Paes and Barbosa came to India during his reign.

10 Though a Vaishnavite, he respected all religions. Eight eminent scholars of Telugu known as the 'Ashta diggajas' adorned his court.



KASHMIR

MULTAN

DELHI
SULTANATE
(Lodhi)

SAMMA

RAJPUT
STATES

MEWAR

MALWA

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA

AHMAD-
NAGAR

BERAR

BIJAPUR
SULTANATE

BAHMANI

RAICHUR
(KARNANTAKA)

GAJAPATI

TUNGABHADRA
GOA (Por.)

KRISHANA

NAGALAPURAM
(CHITTOOR)

Arabian Sea

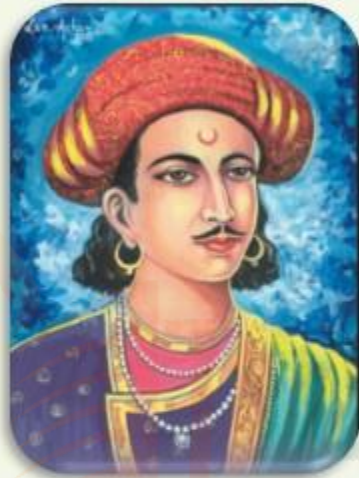
VIJAYANAGARA
EMPIRE

Bay of Bengal

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

KRISHNA DEVA RAYA (1509–1529 AD)



IMPORTANT SCHOLARS TO REMEMBER

- 11**
- 1) **Allasani Peddanna** (the greatest, who was also called Andhrakavita Pitamaga); his important works include Manucharitam and Harikathasaram.
 - 2) **Tenali Ramakrishna**, author of Panduranga Mahatyam.
 - 3) **Pingali Suranna**, author of Garuda Puranam,
- 12** He himself authored
- ✓ **Amuktha-malyadha** (Telugu)
 - ✓ **Jambavati Kalyanam**
 - ✓ **Usha-parinayam** (Sanskrit)

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

KRISHNA DEVA RAYA (1509–1529 AD)



- 13 He built some fine stone temples such as famous the **Vittalaswamy** at Vijayanagar.
- 14 The famous temple of Tirupati greatly developed (not built) during his period as the deity there was his titular deity.
- 15 He also founded a suburban township near Vijayanagar called **Nagalapuram** after his mother.



VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

ACHYUTA DEVA RAYA (1529–1542 AD)



- 1 He was the younger brother of Krishna Deva Raya, who handpicked him to be his successor.
- 2 A Portuguese traveller, Fernoa Nuniz, came to India during his reign.
- 3 The Tiru-vengala-natha temple, which is now popularly known by his name as the Achyutaraya temple, was built in Vijayanagar during his reign.
- 4 Purandardas, known as 'father of Carnatic Music' lived in his court.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

SADA SIVA RAYA

(1542–1570 AD)



1

- Last ruler of Tuluva dynasty.
- He was a puppet in the hands of his minister, Aliya Rama Raya, who was the de facto king.

2

- He removed the old nobility and replaced it with those loyal to him.

3

- The Deccan states (Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golkonda and Bidar, except Berar) formed a confederacy and inflicted a crushing blow on the Vijayanagar armies in the **Battle Of Talaikotta** in 1565 AD. This battle is also known as **Rakshasa Thangadi**.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - TULUVAS DYNASTY

SADA SIVA RAYA

(1542–1570 AD)



- 4 Rama Raya was imprisoned and executed and the city of Vijayanagar was destroyed.
- 5 However, the Vijayanagar kingdom continued to exist under the **Aravidu dynasty**, which ruled from Penukonda and later from **Chandragiri** (near Tirupati) for about another century.
- 6 The **last ruler of Vijayanagar kingdom** was **Sri Ranga III** (1642–1646 AD).



KASHMIR

DELHI
SULTANATE

RAJPUT
STATES

TARKHAN

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

MEWAR

GONDWANA

GUJARAT SULTANATE

BERAR

AHMAD-
NAGAR

GAJAPATI

BIJAPUR
SULTANATE

GOLKONDA

GOA (Por.)

MYSORE

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

MADURAI

VIJAYANAGARAS

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

ADMINISTRATION



- 1 There was a well-organised administration under the Vijayanagar kingdom.
- 2 King had absolute power in executive, judicial and legislative matters. King was the highest court of appeal.
- 3 Succession to throne was on the basis of heredity. Sometimes, the throne was usurped as in the case of Saluva Narasimha, ending the Sangama dynasty.
- 4 King was assisted by council of minister in his day to day activities.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

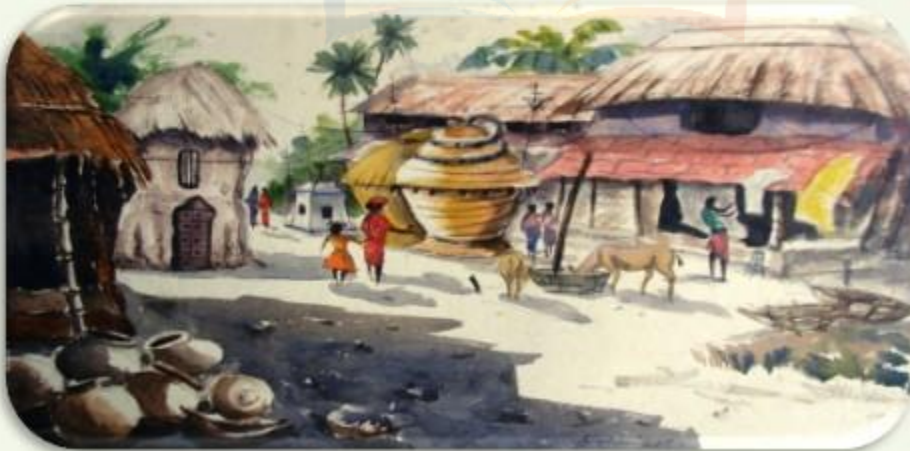
ADMINISTRATION

- 5 Empire was divided into different administrative units
 - ✓ Mandalams,
 - ✓ Nadus,
 - ✓ Sthalas, and
 - ✓ Gramas.
- 6 Governor of Mandalam was called Mandaleswara or Nayak.
- 7 Vijayanagar rulers gave full powers to the local authorities in the administration.
- 8 It is pertinent to note that the Chola traditions of village self-government were considerably weakened under the Vijaynagar rulers. The growth of hereditary Nayakships tended to curb their freedom and initiative
- 9 Harsh punishments such as mutilation and throwing to elephants were followed.
- 10 Besides land revenue, tributes, and gifts from vassals and feudal chiefs, customs collected at the ports, taxes on various professions, were other sources of income to the government.
- 11 Land revenue was fixed at generally one sixth of the produce.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

ECONOMY



- 1 According to the accounts of the foreign travelers, the Vijayanagar kingdom was one of the wealthiest kingdoms of the world at that time.
- 2
 - Agriculture continued to be the chief occupation of the people.
 - The Vijayanagar rulers provided a stimulus to its further growth by providing irrigation facilities.
 - New tanks were built and dams were constructed across the rivers like Tungabhadra.
- 3
 - There were numerous industries and they were organised into guilds.
 - Metal workers and other craftsmen flourished during this period.
 - Diamond mines were located in Kurnool and Anantapur district.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

ECONOMY



- 4 Vijayanagar was also a great centre of trade.

- 5 The chief gold coin was the **varaha** but weights and measures varied from place to place.
- 6 There were a number of seaports on the Malabar coast, the chief being **Cannanore (Kannur)**
- 7 Commercial contacts with **Arabia, Persia, South Africa, and Portugal** on the west, and with **Burma, the Malay peninsulam and China** on the east flourished.
- 8 The chief items of exports were **cotton and silk clothes, spices, rice, iron, saltpetre, and sugar**. The imports consisted of **horses, pearls, copper, coral, mercury, China silk, and velvet clothes**.
- 9 The art of shipbuilding had developed.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

MILITARY ADMINISTRATION



- 1 It was well-organized and efficient
- 2 Consisted of cavalry, infantry, artillery and elephants
- 3 High breed horses were procured from foreign traders
- 4
 - Top grade officers of army were **Nayaks or Poligars.**
 - They got land in lieu for the services which was called **Amaram.**
- 5 Soldiers were usually paid in cash.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

SOCIAL LIFE



1 Peddanna in Manucharitam refers to 4 castes existing

- ✓ Brahmins
- ✓ Kshatriyas
- ✓ Vaishyas and
- ✓ Sudras.

2 Silk and cotton clothes were mainly used for dress. Perfumes, flowers and ornaments were used by the people.

3 Domingo Paes (Portuguese) mentions beautiful houses of the rich with a large number of household servants

4 Nicolo Conti refers to the prevalence of slavery.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

SOCIAL LIFE



- 5 Dancing, Music, Wrestling, Gambling and Cock-Fighting were some amusements.
- 6 Among Vijaynagara dynisties, Sangama rullers were Shaivites while the others were Vaishnavaites.
- 7 Srivaishnavism of Ramanuja was popular among the people and ruling classes.
- 8 All rulers were tolerant of other religions. Borbosa mentions this in his writing.
- 9 Muslims were employed in the administration and freely allowed to build mosques and worship.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

SOCIAL LIFE



- 10** A large number of temples were built, and numerous festivals were celebrated.
- 11** Epics and Puranas were popular among the masses.
- 12** The position of women had not improved. Nuniz noted that a large number of women were employed in the royal palace as dancers, and domestic servants.
- 13** The attachment of dancing girls to temples was common. Paes referred to the Devadasi System which was flourishing.
- 14** Polygamy was prevalent among royal families. Sati was honoured and Nuniz gives a description of this.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

SOCIAL LIFE

KEY TERMS TO REMEMBER

PRADHANI	→	PRIME MINISTER
RAYSANI	→	RECORDED ORAL ORDER OF KING
KARNIKAM	→	ACCOUNTANT
KADAMAL, IRAI, VRAI	→	KINDS OF TAXES
ATHAVANE	→	LAND REVENUE DEPARTMENT
MAHANAYAKACHARYA	→	ACTED AS LINKAGE BETWEEN KINGS AND VILLAGES
PADIKAVAL	→	SELLING OF POLICING RIGHTS
TALARA	→	WATCHMAN

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